BJP chose to go against this and was rewarded with a win in 24 of the 39 seats in which it moved early.

The Congress, on the other hand, promised early ticket distribution but waited till October 15 to come out with its first list. Subsequent lists were marked by infighting and amendments. State party president Kamal Nath was in fact once seen on camera directing irate party workers towards senior party colleague Digvijaya Singh during a protest when tickets were being distributed. The party leadership capitulated and changed candidates at Gotegaon and Sumaoli. The replaced candidates lost because the original candidates continued to be in the fray. Of the 22 seats where Congress rebels contested, the BJP won 19. By contrast, the 22 seats where the BJP rebels contested, the Congress could win only eight.

THE CONGRESS FOLLY

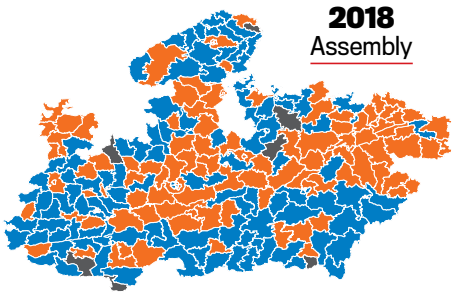
The party's greatest failure was that its leadership could not rein in the rebels. Of the 98 Congress MLAs in the outgoing assembly, only 13 were denied tickets. Of the 85 sitting MLAs who contested the polls, 60 lost. Among the 13 seats where there were new candidates, the Congress lost seven. The BJP, on the other hand, denied tickets to 34 of its 126 MLAs in the outgoing assembly. Of the 97 in the fray, only 27 lost, suggesting that constituency-level anti-incumbency took a heavier toll on the Opposition than on the ruling party.

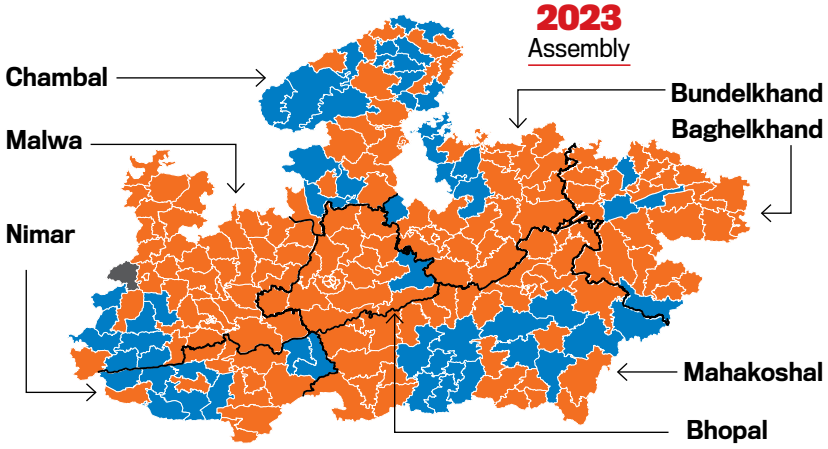
In the months following its Karnataka loss in May, the BJP also keenly waited to see what Nath would announce as his main pitch in MP. In June, the Congress leader made four major announcements: 100 units of free electricity and 50 per cent bill on 200 units, farm loan waiver, Old Pension Scheme for government employees and cooking gas cylinders at Rs 500. Chouhan had in March announced what he believed would be the 'game changer' for the MP election, the Ladli Behna Yojana (LBY). The payment of Rs 1,000 per month to nearly 13 million women covered under the scheme began on June 10, allowing the BJP to put money in the hands of the beneficiaries before the Congress even put its promises on paper. In speech after speech, Chouhan reminded the electorate that Nath as CM in 2019 had stopped his Sambal Yojana and would do the same to LBY, too, if he came to power. The Congress, then, was forced to announce its own version of LBY—the Mahila Samman Yojana—

MADHYA PRADESH

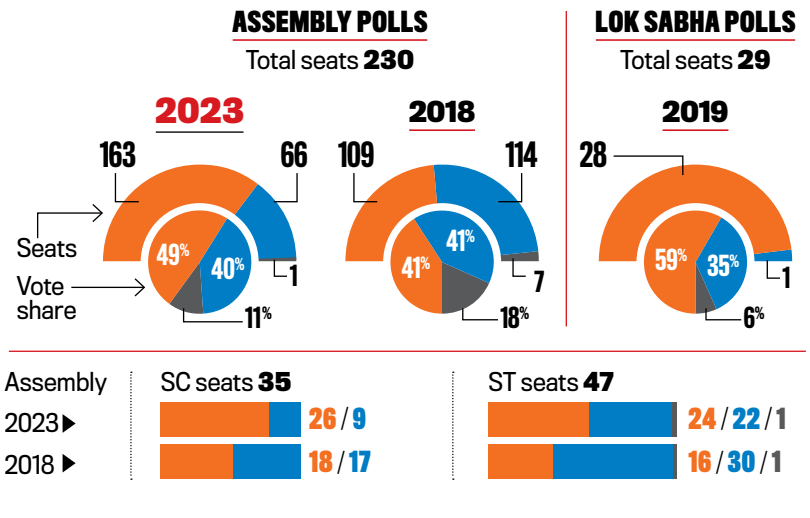
SAFFRON SWEEP

THE BJP HAS EXPANDED ITS SEAT SHARE IN ALL REGIONS. THE CONGRESS'S BEST PERFORMANCE CAME IN THE TRIBAL-DOMINATED POCKETS OF THE STATE'S EASTERN, WESTERN AND NORTHERN REGIONS





HOW THE PARTIES FARED



Source: Election Commission of India